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van Sambeek

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(54) **PHLOX PLANT NAMED ‘DOPHLEARLAPOP’**

(50) Latin Name: *Phlox paniculata*
Varietal Denomination: **Dophlearlapop**

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(*) Notice: Subject to any disclaimer, the term of this
patent is extended or adjusted under 35
U.S.C. 154(b) by 0 days.

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(51) **Int. Cl.**
A01H 5/02 (2018.01)
A01H 6/70 (2018.01)

(52) **U.S. Cl.**
USPC **Plt./320**

(58) **Field of Classification Search**

USPC Plt./263.1, 320
See application file for complete search history.

(56) **References Cited**

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

PP11,804 P2 * 3/2001 Bartels A01H 6/70
Plt./320

* cited by examiner

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(57) **ABSTRACT**

A new and distinct cultivar of *Phlox* plant named ‘Dophle-
arlapop’, characterized by its upright and uniform plant
habit; vigorous growth habit and rapid growth rate; freely
branching habit; early and freely flowering habit; large light
purple-colored flowers with reddish purple-colored centers;
and good container and garden performance.

2 Drawing Sheets

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Botanical designation: *Phlox paniculata*.

Cultivar denomination: ‘DOPHLEARLAPOP’.

**CROSS-REFERENCED TO CLOSELY-RELATED
APPLICATION:**

An European Community Plant Breeder’s Rights appli-
cation for the instant plant was filed by the Applicant/
Assignee, Dümme Group B.V. of De Lier, The Netherlands
on Aug. 15, 2022, application number 2022/1927. Foreign
priority is not claimed to this application.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

The present invention relates to a new and distinct cultivar
of *Phlox* plant, botanically known as *Phlox paniculata* and
hereinafter referred to by the name ‘Dophlearlapop’.

The new *Phlox* plant is a product of a planned breeding
program conducted by the Inventor in Aalsmeer, The Neth-
erlands. The objective of the breeding program was to create
new early and freely-flowering *Phlox* plants with attractive
flower color.

The new *Phlox* plant originated from a cross-pollination
in July, 2014 of a proprietary selection of *Phlox paniculata*
identified as code number PA11-000024-001, not patented,
as the female, or seed, parent with a proprietary selection of
Phlox paniculata identified as code number PA09-000103-
001, not patented, as the male, or pollen, parent. The new
Phlox plant was discovered and selected by the Inventor as
a single flowering plant within the progeny of the stated
cross-pollination in a controlled environment in Aalsmeer,
The Netherlands in July, 2015.

Asexual reproduction of the new *Phlox* plant by vegeta-
tive cuttings in a controlled environment in Aalsmeer, The
Netherlands since August, 2015 has shown that the unique

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features of this new *Phlox* plant are stable and reproduced
true to type in successive generations.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

Plants of the new *Phlox* have not been observed under all
possible combinations of environmental conditions and cul-
tural practices. The phenotype may vary somewhat with
variations in environmental conditions such as temperature
and light intensity without, however, any variance in geno-
type.

The following traits have been repeatedly observed and
are determined to be the unique characteristics of ‘Dophle-
arlapop’. These characteristics in combination distinguish
‘Dophlearlapop’ as a new and distinct *Phlox* plant:

1. Upright and uniform plant habit.
2. Vigorous growth habit and rapid growth rate.
3. Freely branching habit.
4. Early and freely flowering habit.
5. Large light purple-colored flowers with reddish purple-
colored centers.
6. Good container and garden performance.

Plants of the new *Phlox* differ from plants of the female
parent selection primarily in flower color as plants of the
new *Phlox* have light purple-colored flowers with reddish
purple-colored centers whereas plants of the female parent
selection have red-colored flowers with pink-colored cen-
ters.

Plants of the new *Phlox* differ from plants of the male
parent selection primarily in plant habit as plants of the new
Phlox are more mounding and uniform in plant habit than
plants of the male parent selection.

Plants of the new *Phlox* can be compared to plants of
Phlox paniculata ‘Sweet Summer Ocean’, not patented. In

side-by-side comparisons, plants of the new *Phlox* and 'Sweet Summer Ocean' differ in the following characteristics:

1. Plants of the new *Phlox* have smaller leaves than plants of 'Sweet Summer Ocean'.
2. Plants of the new *Phlox* flower earlier than plants of 'Sweet Summer Ocean'.
3. Plants of the new *Phlox* have smaller flowers than plants of 'Sweet Summer Ocean'.
4. Plants of the new *Phlox* have light purple-colored flowers with reddish purple-colored centers whereas plants of 'Sweet Summer Ocean' have bluish purple-colored flowers.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE PHOTOGRAPHS

The accompanying colored photographs illustrate the overall appearance of the new *Phlox* plant showing the colors as true as it is reasonably possible to obtain in colored reproductions of this type. Colors in the photographs may differ slightly from the color values cited in the detailed botanical description which accurately describe the colors of the new *Phlox* plant.

The photograph on the first sheet (FIG. 1) is a side perspective view of typical flowering plant of 'Dophlearlapop' grown in a container.

The photograph on the second sheet (FIG. 2) are close-up views of typical leaves, flower buds and flowers of 'Dophlearlapop'.

DETAILED BOTANICAL DESCRIPTION

The aforementioned photographs and following observations, measurements and values describe plants grown during the late spring and early summer in 13-cm containers in an outdoor nursery in Straelen, Germany and under cultural practices typical of commercial *Phlox* production. During the production of the plants, day temperatures averaged 21° C. and night temperatures averaged 15° C. Plants were pinched one time one week after planting rooted young plants and were 14 weeks old when the photographs and the description were taken. In the following description, color references are made to The Royal Horticultural Society Colour Chart, Fifth Edition, except where general terms of ordinary dictionary significance are used.

Botanical classification: *Phlox paniculata* 'Dophlearlapop'.
Parentage:

Female, or seed, parent.—Proprietary selection of *Phlox paniculata* identified as code number PA11-000024-001, not patented.

Male, or pollen, parent.—Proprietary selection of *Phlox paniculata* identified as code number PA09-000103-001, not patented.

Propagation:

Type.—By vegetative cuttings.

Time to initiate roots, summer.—About 16 days at temperatures about 26° C.

Time to initiate roots, winter.—About three weeks at temperatures about 23° C.

Time to produce a rooted young plant, summer.—About 24 days at temperatures about 23° C.

Time to produce a rooted young plant, winter.—About four weeks at temperatures about 18° C.

Root description.—Thick, fibrous; typically white in color, actual color of the roots is dependent on

substrate composition, water quality, fertilizer type and formulation, substrate temperature and physiological age of roots.

Rooting habit.—Moderately freely branching; medium density.

Plant description:

Plant and growth habit.—Herbaceous perennial typically grown as a container and garden plant; upright and uniform plant habit; vigorous growth habit and rapid growth rate.

Plant height.—About 24 cm.

Plant width (spread).—About 27 cm.

Lateral branches.—Branching habit: Relatively freely branching habit; about six primary branches each with about twelve secondary branches developing per plant. Length: About 18 cm. Diameter: About 3 mm. Internode length: About 2.8 cm. Strength: Strong. Aspect: Upright to about 65° from vertical. Texture and luster: Smooth, glabrous; glossy. Color, developing and developed: Close to 143A; at the internodes, close to 187A.

Leaf description:

Arrangement.—Opposite, simple; decussate.

Length.—About 6.7 cm.

Width.—About 1.8 cm.

Shape.—Lanceolate.

Apex.—Acuminate.

Base.—Obtuse.

Margin.—Entire.

Texture and luster, upper and lower surfaces.—Smooth, glabrous; semi-glossy.

Venation pattern.—Pinnate, reticulate.

Color.—Developing leaves, upper surface: Close to N137B. Developing leaves, lower surface: Close to 138A. Fully expanded leaves, upper surface: Close to N137A; venation, close to N137A. Fully expanded leaves, lower surface: Close to 138A; venation, close to N137D.

Petioles.—Length: About 2 mm. Diameter: About 3 mm. Strength: Strong; flexible. Texture and luster, upper and lower surfaces: Smooth, glabrous; semi-glossy. Color, upper surface: Close to 187A. Color, lower surface: Close to 138A.

Flower description:

Flower type and flowering habit.—Single rotate and salverform flowers arranged in compound terminal and lateral panicles; flowers face mostly upright to slightly outwardly depending on position on inflorescence; freely flowering habit with about ten flowers per inflorescence and about 1,056 flowers developing per plant during the flowering season.

Fragrance.—Slightly fragrant; sweet, pleasant.

Natural flowering season.—Early flowering habit; plants begin flowering about ten weeks after planting; plants flower in July in the garden in Germany and The Netherlands; flowers persistent.

Flower buds.—Height: About 1.4 cm. Diameter: About 3 mm. Shape: Conical. Texture and luster: Smooth, glabrous; matte. Color: Close to N81A.

Inflorescence height.—About 10 cm.

Inflorescence diameter.—About 12 cm.

Flower diameter.—About 2 cm.

Flower depth.—About 1.5 cm.

Flower throat diameter.—About 3 mm.

Flower tube length.—About 9 mm.

Flower diameter, proximally.—About 3 mm.

Petals.—Quantity per flower: Typically five in a single whorl; petals fused at the base into a narrow tube. Lobe length: About 1 cm. Lobe width: About 9 mm. Lobe shape: Obovate. Lobe apex: Rounded. Lobe margin: Entire, not undulate. Lobe texture and luster, upper and lower surfaces: Smooth, glabrous; matte. Throat texture and luster: Smooth, glabrous; matte. Tube texture and luster: Pubescent; matte. Color: Lobe, when opening, upper surface: Close to 85A; towards the throat, close to N82A and N78A. Lobe, when opening, lower surface: Close to N81A and N82B. Lobe, fully opened, upper surface: Close to 77B; towards the throat, close to N74A; venation, similar to lamina colors; colors do not change with subsequent development. Lobe, fully opened, lower surface: Close to N81B and N82B; venation, similar to lamina colors; colors do not change with subsequent development. Throat: Close to N74A; venation, close to N74A. Tube: Close to N77B; venation, close to N77B.

Sepals.—Quantity per flower: Typically five in a single whorl, fused towards the base; calyx, tubular. Length: About 9 mm. Width: About 1 mm. Shape: Subulate. Apex: Acuminate. Margin: Entire. Texture and luster, upper and lower surfaces: Smooth, glabrous; matte. Color: When opening, upper and lower surfaces: Close to 144A. Fully opened, upper and lower surfaces: Close to 144A.

Peduncles.—Length: About 1.3 cm. Diameter: About 2 mm. Strength: Moderately strong. Aspect: About 45°

from lateral branch axis. Texture and luster: Smooth, glabrous; glossy. Color: Close to 146A.

Pedicels.—Length: About 1 mm. Diameter: About 1 mm. Strength: Weak. Aspect: About 45° from peduncle axis. Texture and luster: Smooth, glabrous; glossy. Color: Close to 144A.

Reproductive organs.—Stamens: Quantity per flower: Typically five. Filament length: About 1 mm. Filament color: Close to N77B. Anther size: About 0.5 mm by 1 mm. Anther color: Close to 162B. Pollen amount: None observed. Pistils: Quantity per flower: One. Pistil length: About 1.5 cm. Stigma diameter: About 1 mm. Stigma shape: Three-parted. Stigma color: Close to 145A. Style length: About 1.1 cm. Style color: Close to 145A. Ovary color: Close to 143B.

Seeds and fruits.—To date, seed and fruit development have not been observed on plants of the new *Phlox*.

Garden performance: Plants of the new *Phlox* have been observed to have good garden performance and to tolerate rain, wind and temperatures ranging from about -30° C. to about 30° C. and to be suitable for USDA Hardiness Zones 3 through 9.

Pathogen & pest resistance: To date, plants of the new *Phlox* have not been observed to be resistant to pathogens and pests common to *Phlox* plants.

It is claimed:

1. A new and distinct *Phlox* plant named 'Dophlearlapop' as illustrated and described.

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FIG. 1

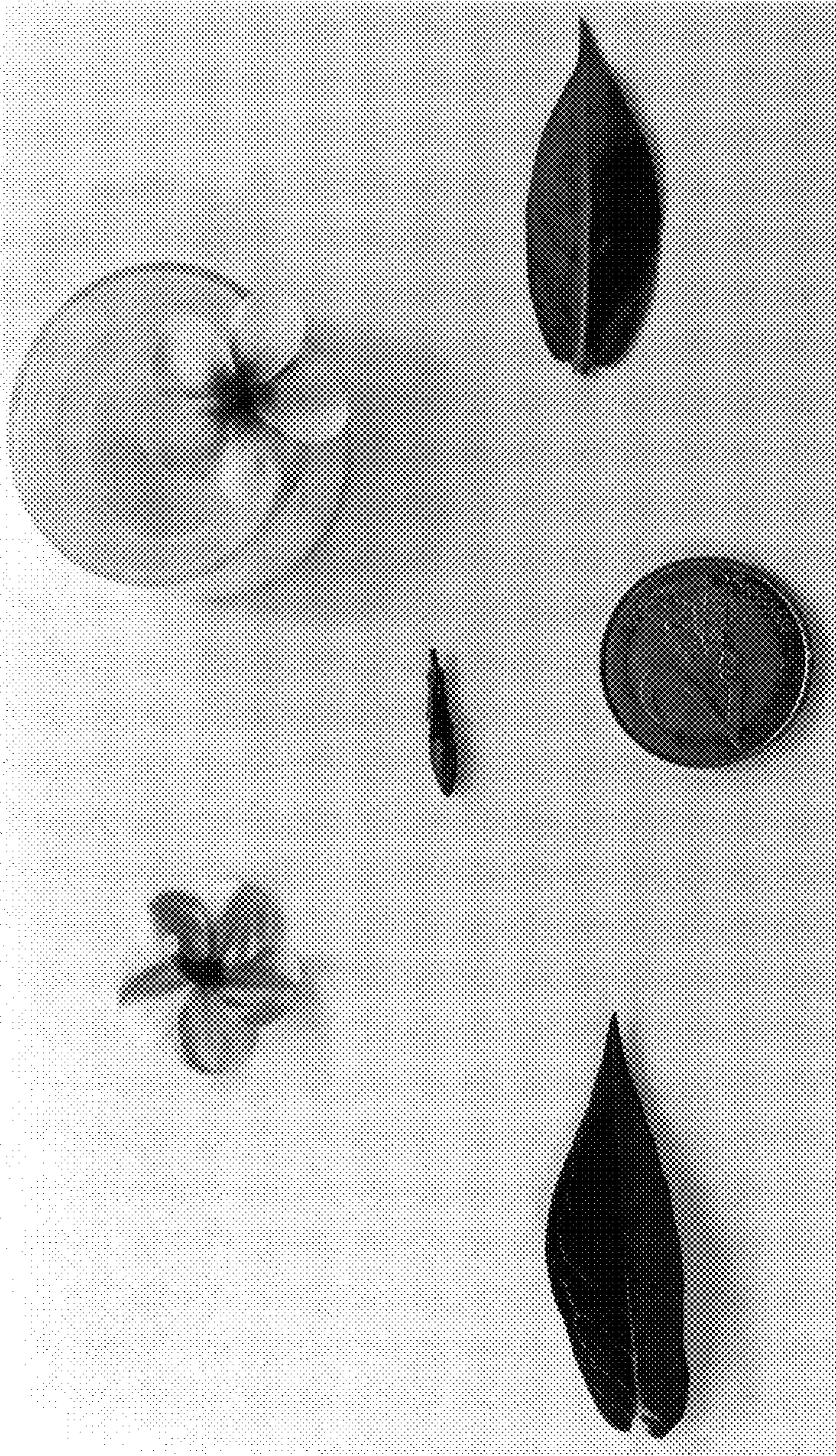


FIG. 2